

Harini R

Product Manager Intern
Appian

About Appian

Appian is a low-code automation company that helps organizations build applications quickly with minimal coding effort. Appian recently introduced a Product Manager Intern role for undergraduates, alongside Software Engineer, Quality Engineer, and User Design tracks.

About the Role

As a Product Manager Intern, I will not have people reporting to me directly, but I will be part of the entire process from gathering client requirements to delivering and managing the product being part of the product's lifecycle.

Selection Stages

Online Test (45 mins)

The test had 4 questions - 2 written and 2 video responses (recorded live, 3 minutes each).

Topics included:

- My favorite digital product and one improvement I would suggest
- A day in the life of a Product Manager (as I imagine it)
- Handling team disagreements over a feature design
- Responding differently to a customer vs. a stakeholder when I do not know the answer

Interviews (3 rounds, all in one day)

Round 1 (45 mins – Technical PM focus):

- Centered on product evaluation and prioritization
- Products discussed: Duolingo, Google Docs, and WhatsApp
- I was asked to analyze features, assess metrics, prioritize trade-offs, and defend decisions
- The interviewer kept probing deeper. It felt like a stress test of my thinking process and structured problem-solving, not about “knowing the answer”
- I made sure to voice my reasoning and ask clarifying questions

Round 2 (20–25 mins – Technical + HR):

- More product-based questions
- Behavioral questions like: What motivates you? What demotivates you?

Round 3 (5 mins – HR wrap-up):

- Mostly role explanation and background discussion

Preparation Approach

Since undergrad PM internships are rare and resources limited, I prepared by:

- Learning PM metrics, product assessment frameworks, and feature analysis methods
- Watching mock PM interviews
- Practicing mock questions responses to improve clarity and structured speaking

The selection was less about having a “correct” answer and more about how I approach problems, structure my thoughts, and communicate clearly under pressure.